applications but doesn't overwhelm you with concepts, as the legacy ASP.NET framework did. On the other hand, if you're familiar with .NET, it's worth considering whether now is the time to take a look at ASP.NET Core.

2.4.2 If you're a .NET Framework developer creating a new application

If you're already a .NET Framework developer, you've likely been aware of .NET Core and ASP.NET Core, but perhaps you were wary about jumping in too soon or didn't want to hit the inevitable "version 1" problems. The good news is that ASP.NET Core and .NET are now mature, stable platforms, and it's absolutely time to consider using .NET 7 for your new apps.

As a .NET developer, if you aren't using any Windows-specific constructs such as the Registry, the ability to build and deploy cross-platform opens the possibility for cheaper Linux hosting in the cloud, or for developing natively in macOS without the need for a virtual machine.

.NET Core and .NET 7 are inherently cross-platform, but you can still use platform-specific features if you need to. Windows-specific features such as the Registry and Directory Services, for example, can be enabled with a Compatibility Pack that makes these APIs available in .NET 5+. They're available only when running .NET 5+ in Windows, not Linux or macOS, so you need to take care that such applications run only in a Windows environment or account for the potential missing APIs.

TIP The Windows Compatibility Pack is designed to help port code from .NET Framework to .NET Core/.NET 5+. See http://mng.bz/2DeX.